

Gradual Exposure 5.3

How do I get closer to what scares or stresses me — one step at a time?

We build a small, graded ladder from easier steps to harder ones, so I can move forward without overwhelming myself.



What do I want to practice doing?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

How scary does it feel?

(0 = not scary at all | 10 = very scary)

My exposure ladder

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 1 – easiest for me **1**

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 2 **2**

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 3 **3**

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 4 **4**

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 5 **5**

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Step 6 – most challenging **6**

How will I know that I practiced well?

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

What will help me get started?

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Who can support me?

1. _____
2. _____



Gradual exposure is not one giant leap. Small steps, repetition, and one more step — that is how real courage is built.